Ethical Considerations for Data Science Capstone Project

This project is built on existing data already collected and analyzed by Professor Alison Harris's lab at Claremont McKenna. All participants provided informed consent. The study did not put any individuals at risk, as recording EEG is non-invasive and participants only had to watch short clips of PLDs. The data is saved using the participants' codes rather than their names, which reduces privacy concerns, and the data wasn't shared beyond the project. Even so, EEG signals can be distinctive to an individual, so the data should still be treated as sensitive rather than fully anonymous. To avoid only presenting information that is favorable for my investigation, I made sure to present all three RCA components and didn't remove any findings that did not support my hypothesis. Additionally, the spatial filters were estimated on both conditions together, and thus the analysis did not favor either condition. Finally, ISC is measured on a group level, specifically how similar people's brain responses are when looking at biological movement compared to. scrambled movement. It does not say anything about how well a person perceives biological movement, and therefore the results should not be used to draw conclusions about individuals or generalized beyond the population that was sampled.